The RSR programme was responsible for the development and fabrication of sounding rockets and their associated on-board systems for scientific investigations in India. Under this programme, a family of operational sounding rockets were developed. These rockets had wide ranging capabilities, and to date several hundreds of these rockets have been launched for various scientific and technological studies.

I stil remember that the first Rohini rocket consisted of a single solid propulsion motor weighing a mere 32 kg. It lifted a nominal 7 kg payload to an altitude of about 10 km. It was soon fol owed by another, to which one more solid propel ant stage was added to dispatch multi-experiment payloads weighing nearly 100 kg to an altitude of over 350 km.

The development of these rockets had resulted in a ful y indigenous capability in the production of sounding rockets as wel as their propel ants. This programme had brought into the country technology for the production of very high-performance solid propel ants, like those based on polyurethane and polybutane polymer. It later resulted in the setting up of a Propel ant Fuel Complex (PFC) to